

Pre-work checklist

Do this **at home, a few days before** the workshop. Every install you finish now is time we spend building together instead of troubleshooting.

Time needed: about 20–30 minutes · **Bring:** your laptop, charger, and GitHub login.

Golden rule (starts now): never paste a password or access token into your code, a README, a prompt, or a committed `.env` file. Use browser sign-in or environment variables.

The main objective is Codex Desktop (the ChatGPT desktop app with Codex). Everything else supports getting your project onto GitHub. If a step below is already done, just check the box and move on.

Already have Git & GitHub set up? Great — you're on the **fast track**. Confirm `git --version` and `gh --version` both work and you're signed in with `gh auth status`, then skip straight to the Codex items in sections 2–3. Your only must-do is **Codex Desktop**.

1 · Accounts do these first — approvals can take a day

☐	GitHub account created, with a verified email. Check your inbox for the GitHub verification link if you just signed up.
☐	ChatGPT account with Codex access — the student plan/offer that includes Codex. Confirm you can actually open Codex inside ChatGPT, not just sign in.

2 · Installs verify each with the command shown

■	ChatGPT desktop app installed and signed in; Codex opens.
■	Codex CLI installed → verify <code>codex --version</code> macOS: <code>brew install --cask codex</code> · any OS with Node 18+: <code>npm install -g @openai/codex</code>
■	Git installed → verify <code>git --version</code>
■	GitHub CLI installed → verify <code>gh --version</code>

Windows students: the Codex CLI runs inside **WSL2 (Ubuntu)**, not PowerShell. Enable WSL2 and install the tools inside your Ubuntu terminal **before** class — this is the most common thing that stalls people on the day.

3 · Two-minute self-test proves it actually works

■	In the ChatGPT desktop app, open Codex and select a local folder .
■	Send one simple request to Codex and get a response back.
■	Create one empty folder named <code>my-portfolio</code> to use in class.

If any command prints an error: close the terminal, open a new one, and try again. Still stuck? Finish the install using the Installation Guide — don't try to fix it for the first time during the workshop.

4 · What we'll build together so you know what you're walking into

In the hour, you'll create a one-page personal site with Codex, review the changes, and **publish it to your own public GitHub repository** using the GitHub CLI. You'll leave with a live project and a repeatable workflow: **Describe** → **Build** → **Review** → **Commit** → **Push** → **Inspect**.

Arrive ready: if all the boxes above are checked, you'll spend the workshop building — not installing. See you there!